Marie Wako

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EDUCATION / QUALIFICATION/AWARDS

Stanford Law School, Stanford, CA — August 2022 - Present
Candidate for JSD Degree (Ph.D. equivalent in Law)
Research interest: Race and Law, Criminal Law, Criminal Procedure, Evidence, NLP, International Law
Research Assistant for Prof. Alfredo Artiles, Prof. Bill Koski for Larry P. v Riles Project — Winter 25 -Present
Pre-doctoral Fellow at the Walter H. Shorenstein Asia-Pacific Research Center, FSI, Stanford — (AY 24-25)
Center for Spatial and Textual Analysis Digital Humanities Research Scholar — (AY 24-25)
Japan Dissertation Fellow, Freeman Spogli Institute for International Studies (FSI), Stanford — (AY 24-26)
Graduate Dissertation Fellow, Center for Comparative Studies in Race and Ethnicity, Stanford — (AY 26-27)
Lieberman Fellow, Stanford University (deferred) — (AY 26-27)

Stanford Law School, Stanford, CA — August 2021-June 2022
LL.M. degree in International Economic Law, Business & Policy
Gerald Gunther Prize for Outstanding Performance (Contracts, Prof. Robert Gordon)
Fulbright Scholar; Research Assistant for Prof. Allen Weiner; Member editor of the Stanford Journal of Public International Law

University of Tokyo, School of Law, Tokyo, Japan — 2013 - 2015
Degree: Juris Doctor (U.S. J.D. equivalent), Cum Laude
Oda Award, Japanese Society of International Law's Highest Award
- Thesis competition funded by former ICJ Judge Shigeru Oda
- Authored winning thesis in Japanese: "Standard of Review in International Courts"

University of Tokyo, Faculty of Law, Tokyo, Japan — 2008 - 2013
Degree: LL.B.

QUALIFICATION

New York Bar — October 2022

Japanese Bar Admission, Tokyo, Japan — December 2015
Ranked in the top 1%, Public International Law essay test ranked 2nd

WORK / INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

Nishimura & Asahi Law Firm — Tokyo, Japan
Associate — 2016 - 2021
- Advised government agencies and private companies on public international law, international trade law, export controls, and economic sanctions. Work included strategic analysis of ongoing and potential international dispute settlement, WTO litigation and drafting before the Dispute Settlement Body, treaty drafting and implementation advice, ISDS-related research and reporting for the Japanese government, and export-control and sanctions compliance counseling for domestic and foreign companies.

Legal Training & Research Institute of Japan — Tokyo, Japan
Legal Apprentice — 2015 - 2016
- Worked for a district court (civil & criminal), a prosecutor's office, private law firm, and the Ministry of Foreign Affairs Dispute Settlement Division

ICC Trial Chambers — The Hague, Netherlands

Intern to Judges K. Ozaki and R. Fremr June - October 2015

- Conducted in-depth legal research and analysis of questions concerning the Rome Statute and Rules of Evidence and Procedure. Analyzed evidence. Drafted decisions and summaries of submissions and decisions. Prepared witness reference documents sent to judges prior to witness testimonies

United Nations Human Rights Committee 104th Session New York, U.S.
Assistant to Vice-Chairperson Prof. Yuji Iwasawa March 2012

- Drafted questions addressed to the Yemen delegates concerning "Social Status of Women," "Legal Status of Women," and "Abuses of Children" in Yemen, by analyzing differences between the International Convention on Civil and Political Rights and the domestic laws of Yemen

PROBONO ACTIVITIES / SERVICE

Assisting with University Sexual Harassment Cases

- Successfully negotiated with the school-wide Administrative Office for Harassment Countermeasures, had the case discussed in a faculty meeting of the department, and had the assailant officially disciplined.

Member of Domestic Violence Pro Bono Project at Stanford Law School

- Support survivors of domestic violence by providing direct legal services to survivors of domestic violence seeking civil remedies in partner with Bay Area Legal Aid. Conducting interviews, preparing court filings, discussing with survivors on appropriate possible redress

PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

Presentation “Racialized Language in Criminal Courtrooms” California Racial Justice Act Conference, University of California, Irvine, Oct. 2026

Presentation “Effects of Female Judges in Japanese Criminal Courts” Asian Law Junior Scholars Workshop, Harvard Law School, Jul. 2026

Presentation “Racialized Language in Criminal Courtrooms” Law and Society Association Annual Conference, May. 2026

Selected Presentation “How Judicial Gender Composition Affects Sentencing Decisions: Evidence from Japanese Criminal Courts” 19th Annual Conference on Empirical Legal Studies (CELS), October. 2025

Invited Presentation "Female Voice in the Courtroom: Effects of the Participation of Female Judges in Japanese Criminal Cases" at Trans-Altai Sustainability Dialogue, Gender Equality, co-hosted by the Parliament of Mongolia, Stanford University’s APARC, and the Ban Ki-moon Foundation For a Better Future, July. 2023

Presentation at Salzburg Cutler Fellows Program, workshop presentation on the effectiveness of labor provisions in trade agreements, Feb. 2023

"Report by the “CLOUD Act Study Group” — Legal Analysis and Proposals on Criminal Investigations Obtaining Data Held by Companies —", Nishimura Institute of Advanced Legal Studies, 2019 (Co-authored)

"Japan Chapter on Sanctions", in The International Comparative Legal Guide to: Sanctions 2020 and 2021, Global Legal Group Ltd., London, UK, 2020 and 2021 (Co-authored)

"Foreign Investment Screening in Japan", in the Yearbook of Socio-Economic Constitutions A Common European Law on Investment Screening (CELIS), Vol. 2020, Springer, (Co-authored)